

MacroLens Daily Brief — July 20, 2026

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Top Headlines

1. Yemen's Houthis declare naval blockade against Saudi Arabia - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-20 20:56

Yemen's Houthis declared a naval blockade against Saudi Arabia, escalating regional conflict and threatening oil shipping routes.

2. After deadly weekend for US troops, Trump vows revenge against Iran - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-20 20:19

President Trump vowed revenge against Iran after a deadly weekend for US troops, raising geopolitical risk and market uncertainty.

3. Houthis announce Saudi naval blockade, threatening new front in US-Iran war - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-20 19:46

Houthis announced a Saudi naval blockade, threatening a new front in the US-Iran war and potentially disrupting oil flows through the Red Sea.

4. Mediators propose 10-day ceasefire to revive Iran-U.S. interim deal, senior Iranian official tells Reuters - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-20 11:48

Mediators proposed a 10-day ceasefire to revive the Iran-U.S. interim deal, offering a potential de-escalation that could lower oil risk premiums.

5. Few tankers enter Hormuz to load oil, LNG floating storage rises, data shows - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-19 23:16

Few tankers entered Hormuz to load oil, while LNG floating storage rose, indicating supply disruptions and elevated energy prices.

6. US pump prices cross \$4 again on renewed Middle East fighting - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-20 12:07

US pump prices crossed \$4 again due to renewed Middle East fighting, pressuring consumer spending and inflation expectations.

7. Dollar gains as US-Iran conflict intensifies; sterling gives back gains - Reuters

Reuters — 2026-07-19 23:46

The dollar gained as US-Iran conflict intensified, while sterling gave back gains, reflecting safe-haven demand and geopolitical risk.

8. **U.S. Treasury yields edge higher as Wall Street monitors Middle East tensions**

CNBC — 2026-07-20 09:25

US Treasury yields rose (10-year to 4.594%, 2-year to 4.211%) as Middle East tensions escalated, despite cooler inflation data and lower jobless claims.

9. **Gold edges down as US-Iran escalation lifts oil prices, rate hike bets - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-07-20 01:40

Gold edged down as US-Iran escalation lifted oil prices and rate hike bets, with higher yields weighing on the non-yielding metal.

10. **Why oil prices haven't gone crazy despite 5 months of US-Iran war - Reuters**

Reuters — 2026-07-20 15:32



Oil prices remained contained despite five months of US-Iran war due to ample global supply, strategic reserves releases, and demand concerns.

Market Snapshot

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
US Equities				
SPY	S&P 500 ETF	743.29	-0.99%	bearish
QQQ	Nasdaq 100 ETF	695.33	-1.50%	bearish
DIA	Dow Jones ETF	520.81	-0.74%	bearish
IWM	Russell 2000 ETF	294.04	-0.52%	bearish
XLK	Technology ETF	175.59	-1.09%	bearish
XLF	Financials ETF	56.26	-0.86%	bearish
US Treasuries				
SHY	2Y Treasury ETF	81.99	-0.01%	neutral
IEF	10Y Treasury ETF	93.84	+0.13%	neutral
TLT	20Y+ Treasury ETF	84.52	+0.37%	neutral
Credit				
LQD	Investment Grade Bond ETF	107.56	+0.06%	neutral
HYG	High Yield Bond ETF	79.65	-0.19%	neutral

Ticker	Name	Price	1D Return	Signal
Commodities				
GLD	Gold ETF	368.41	+0.95%	bullish
SLV	Silver ETF	50.78	+0.77%	bullish
USO	Oil ETF	123.96	+3.91%	bullish
UNG	Natural Gas ETF	10.51	+0.86%	bullish
FX				
UUP	US Dollar Index ETF	28.33	-0.04%	neutral
FXE	Euro ETF	105.61	+0.04%	neutral
FXJ	Japanese Yen ETF	56.51	+0.11%	neutral
Crypto				
BTC-USD	Bitcoin	64690.80	-0.16%	neutral
ETH-USD	Ethereum	1871.51	+0.54%	bullish

Key Macro Indicators

Indicator	Value	As Of
Fed Funds Rate	3.5%	2026-07-20
10Y Breakeven Inflation (%)	2.25	2026-07-20
10Y-2Y Yield Spread (bp)	0.39	2026-07-20
USD Index (Broad)	120.5315	2026-07-17

Major Anomalies

USO — Oil ETF +3.91%

Cause: Oil prices surged due to heightened geopolitical tensions after Houthis declared a naval blockade against Saudi Arabia and Trump vowed revenge against Iran, threatening oil supply disruptions.

Forward Impact: If tensions escalate further, oil prices may continue to rise, but any de-escalation or ceasefire could lead to a sharp reversal.

Macro Data Releases — Today

[Calendar error: 403 Client Error: Forbidden for url: [https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?
from=2026-07-20&to=2026-07-28&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong](https://finnhub.io/api/v1/calendar/economic?from=2026-07-20&to=2026-07-28&token=d88f5hpr01qq4342ton0d88f5hpr01qq4342tong)]

Economic Calendar — Next 7 Days

No upcoming macro events in the next 7 days.

Sector Heat Map

Sector Performance Heatmap			
	1D	5D	1M
Healthcare	-0.4%	+0.2%	+5.8%
Energy	+1.2%	+4.7%	+4.9%
Financials	-0.9%	+1.0%	+3.9%
Real Estate	-0.1%	+2.2%	+1.6%
Utilities	-0.7%	-0.5%	+0.9%
Consumer Staples	-0.7%	+1.3%	+0.2%
Industrials	-0.4%	-1.4%	+0.0%
Communication Services	-1.8%	-0.9%	-1.2%
Consumer Discretionary	-1.6%	-1.5%	-2.4%
Materials	-0.7%	-0.7%	-3.8%
Technology	-1.1%	-5.5%	-5.7%

Hot Now

- **XLV** — Healthcare shows strong 1m momentum with positive 5d and minimal 1d decline
- **XLE** — Energy leads with positive returns across all timeframes, especially 5d and 1m
- **XLF** — Financials have positive 5d and 1m returns despite slight 1d dip

Cold but Worth Watching

- **XLK** — Technology has steep 5d and 1m declines, potential for mean-reversion if oversold
- **XLV** — Consumer Discretionary negative across all timeframes, may bounce from low levels
- **XLB** — Materials negative across all timeframes, could revert if economic data improves

Defensive and energy sectors are leading, while growth and cyclical sectors are underperforming, suggesting a risk-off rotation.

Daily Conclusion

Risk-off rotation into defensive and energy sectors (XLV, XLE) and financials (XLF) amid geopolitical shock from Houthi blockade, while tech (XLK) and consumer discretionary (XLY) weaken.

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